submerged for days. But with the batteries for its electric motors running low, it had no choice but to surface in order to start its diesel engines and recharge its batteries.[1]

As the sub "broached the surface, we bathed her in blue-white light," recalled Slaughter decades later. He watched as "the sub's crewmen streamed out and stripped off their sweat-soaked uniforms," with "expressions of joy and relief" on their faces as they breathed the fresh night air. The difference between the temperature within the sub and outside was at least thirty degrees Celsius. Before coming to the surface, the submariners had been drenched in sweat produced by high temperatures and the short supply of oxygen.

A group of Soviet navy officers appeared on the sub's bridge and the red flag was raised above it. "My lead signalman and I used our flashing light to interrogate the submarine by use of the Cyrillic Transliteration Table, the International Signals Book, and Morse Code," recalled Slaughter, whose specialty was communications. "I asked the submarine to identify itself." The sub's captain, "using his flashing-light operator … replied the sub was Soviet ship X [Korabl' X]." To Slaughter's other question, "Do you require any assistance?" the captain answered "No [*Nyet*]."

Meanwhile the sub got its diesels running and began to recharge its batteries, clearly using every available minute to do so before diving and leading the Americans on a wild chase once again. But recharging batteries was a slow process that took hours, so the pursuers—besides the USS *Cony*, they included ships belonging to a group led by the aircraft carrier USS *Randolph*—and the prey engaged in something of a staring contest. They moved slowly in the warm waters—a lone Soviet submarine surrounded by a flotilla of US Navy destroyers and auxiliary ships.

"Suddenly, a Navy pilot disrupted our serenity," recalled Slaughter, describing an episode that occurred approximately an hour and a half after the submarine came to the surface. "His gigantic P2V Neptune roared over the scene. He dropped several incendiary devices to activate his photoelectric camera lenses. Bam! Bam! Bam! The light flashes were blinding." Slaughter saw the officers on the bridge getting back into the submarine, which turned around minutes later. "Believing he was under